

partner starts maternity leave, she may start a whirlwind of activity in preparation for the new arrival and will need your help to get everything ready.

While supporting your partner both practically and emotionally will be important in the coming weeks, take care of yourself, too. Take every opportunity to get some rest. Even if you've agreed that your partner will do the majority of the nighttime baby care, your sleep will still be disrupted in the weeks after the birth. Catch up with friends now, but not to the point where you tire yourself out, and keep up your exercise routine, if you have one.

It's normal to feel anxious about what's ahead—both being a birth partner and a parent—but be reassured that somehow everything will fall into place. Focus on the thought of holding your newborn baby.